

BLU_D09 — Class 5 Textbook: "My Community, My Responsibility"

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A Note to Students

You are in Class 5 now. That matters.

You have spent four years learning, growing, and practising good manners — how to greet people, how to behave at the table, how to speak kindly. You have come a long way. But this year is different. This year is not just about what you do for yourself. This year is about what you do for others.

This book is called *My Community, My Responsibility* — and it means exactly that. Your community is the street you live on, the school you attend, the masjid, mandir, or church in your neighbourhood, the river near your town. Your community is every person you walk past, sit next to, or share a meal with. And your responsibility is to make that community a little better because you are part of it.

In this book, you will meet two students you may already know — Rafi and Mitu. They are in Class 5 too. They face real situations: a classmate being teased, a street that needs cleaning, a moment when speaking up is hard. Watch how they handle it. Then ask yourself: what would I do?

By the end of this year, you will earn a special title: **Etiquette Ambassador**. That is not just a name — it is a commitment. An ambassador represents something bigger than themselves. You will represent the values of kindness, respect, and responsibility — in your home, your school, and your community.

Bangladesh needs people like you. Are you ready?

A Note to Parents

[NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

(English source text for translation:)

Dear Parents and Guardians,

Your child is now in Class 5 — a year of transition and growing responsibility. This textbook, *My Community, My Responsibility*, is designed to help them think beyond themselves and begin to see the role they can play in building a better community.

Each chapter introduces a community project or challenge that your child will complete — some at school, some in the neighbourhood. We encourage you to participate where you can. When a parent joins a neighbourhood clean-up, attends a class showcase, or simply asks their child about their "Etiquette Ambassador" project at the dinner table, it sends a message no textbook can: *this matters*.

Please look for the **Parent Corner** box at the end of each chapter. These are short prompts — conversation starters, not homework assignments — designed to connect school learning with home life.

If you have questions about the programme, please speak with your child's class teacher.

Thank you for being your child's first and most important teacher.

The Blu Foundation Curriculum Team

A Note to Teachers

This book is built on one principle: **children learn by doing**.

Class 5 is a pivotal year. Students are moving from absorbing rules to internalising values — and the shift is best made through experience, not instruction. Every chapter in this book therefore centres on a **Community Challenge**: a real-world project or action that students plan, execute, and report on. The content of each chapter exists to prepare students for the challenge, not replace it.

What this means for your planning:

- **Read each chapter's Community Challenge before teaching the chapter.** The challenge shapes everything. If students need materials, adult permission, or coordination with another class, plan ahead.
- **Reflection is not optional.** Each chapter ends with a Leadership Reflection question. Give students 10–15 minutes to write or discuss their responses. This is where learning consolidates.
- **The Grand Ambassador Project (Chapter 5) takes the whole term.** Introduce it at the start of the year so students can think ahead. It should be meaningful — resist the urge to assign a default task. Let students choose.
- **Assessment is by doing, not testing.** Evaluate students on the quality of their community actions, their presentations, and the depth of their reflections — not on memorised content.
- **Teacher Notes** appear at the end of each chapter with specific guidance. Do not skip them.

The Blu Foundation's approach rests on research confirming that project-based learning for older primary students produces deeper retention and genuine behavioural change [SOURCE_UK_04]. Trust the process.

Thank you for bringing this curriculum to life. The children in your classroom are the community leaders of the next generation. What you do this year matters enormously.

Chapter 1: I Am a Citizen — Rights and Responsibilities

Learning Objective: Students will name 3 rights and 3 responsibilities of a Bangladeshi citizen, and explain the connection between them.

Project Introduction

Rafi used to think that rules were for adults.

When he was younger, he saw his father stop at a red traffic light even when the road was empty. "Why?" Rafi asked. "There's no one coming." His father smiled. "Someone is always watching, Rafi. And even if they weren't — the rule exists because roads are safer when everyone follows them. The rule protects you, not just the other car."

Rafi is in Class 5 now, and that conversation has stayed with him. He has started to see rules differently — not as restrictions imposed from above, but as agreements that a community makes to protect one another. Bangladesh's Constitution, the highest law of the land, is exactly that: an agreement. It guarantees every citizen certain rights — the right to education, to a safe environment, to practise religion freely, to be heard. These are promises the country makes to its people.

But the Constitution also asks something in return. Rights exist in relationship with responsibilities. You have the right to walk on a clean street; you have the responsibility not to litter it. You have the right to be safe; you have the responsibility not to threaten others. You have the right to an education; you have the responsibility to take it seriously and treat your school with care.

"I used to think rules were for adults," Rafi reflects. "Now I understand — they are for everyone. And I can help uphold them. That is what it means to be a citizen."

Bangladesh was born through sacrifice — through the courage of people who believed in a community worth protecting. Civic pride is not about being loudly patriotic. It is about the quiet, daily decision to be the kind of person who makes Bangladesh better.

Rights and Responsibilities — Two Sides of the Same Coin

My Right	My Corresponding Responsibility
Right to education	Attend school regularly; behave respectfully; support classmates' right to learn
Right to a clean environment	Never litter; dispose of waste properly; protect public spaces
Right to safety	Never bully, threaten, or harm others; report danger to trusted adults
Right to be heard	Listen attentively when others speak; respect different opinions
Right to worship freely	Respect the religious practices and sacred spaces of all communities

Think about it: Can you think of a right you enjoy every day? What responsibility comes with it?

Community Challenge — Week 1

"What Does Being a Good Citizen Mean?"

This week, your task is to interview one elder member of your family — a parent, grandparent, aunt, uncle, or trusted adult — and ask them this question:

"What does being a good citizen mean to you?"

How to do it:

1. Choose your person and ask permission to interview them — explain it is for school.
2. Prepare 2–3 follow-up questions (examples: *Did you ever see someone being a really good citizen? What did they do? Is it harder to be a good citizen today than it was when you were young?*).
3. Listen carefully. Take notes.
4. Prepare a 2-minute presentation for your class.

When presenting:

- Begin by introducing who you interviewed and your relationship to them.
- Share the most interesting thing they said.
- Tell the class: did anything they said change how you think about citizenship?

Leadership Reflection

Write your answer in your notebook, or discuss with a partner.

"How can I model good citizenship for my younger siblings or classmates? What is one thing I could do this week that would show them what a good citizen looks like?"

Teacher Notes

This chapter connects to the foundational values of Bangladesh's 1971 Liberation War — the struggle for freedom was, at its core, a civic act: people claiming rights and accepting the responsibility to fight for them. If appropriate to your school context, briefly discuss the connection: freedom was won by citizens who believed their responsibilities outweighed their fear.

When students present their elder interviews, listen for themes across the class. Common themes (respect, hard work, honesty, community service) can be written on the board and discussed: *Are these the same values the Constitution protects? Why or why not?*

Be attentive to students who may not have easy access to elder family members. Allow them to interview a trusted neighbour, teacher, or school staff member.

Parent Corner

[NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

(English source text for translation:)

This week, ask your child: "What does being a good citizen mean to you?" Listen to their full answer before responding. They have been thinking about this carefully — you may be surprised by what they say. Share your own answer too. Tell them about a time you saw someone being a truly good citizen, or a time you tried to be one yourself. These conversations shape character more than any textbook can.

Chapter 2: Many People, One Bangladesh — Tolerance and Diversity

Virtue: Respect | সম্মান [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

Learning Objective: Students will explain why respect for cultural and religious diversity strengthens communities, and identify at least two practical ways to demonstrate that respect at school.

[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED: Review Chapter 2 for interfaith content sensitivity before printing. Specific areas for review: the Mitu/Priya narrative (page references to follow), and the "What tolerance looks like at school" list. Please confirm all festival references are accurate and treated with equal dignity.]

Project Introduction

Mitu has always liked Eid. She loves the new clothes, the seviyan her mother makes, the way the whole neighbourhood smells of something sweet and celebratory. But this year, something new happened.

Her friend Priya invited her to Durga Puja.

Mitu was a little nervous. She had walked past the puja pandal every year — the bright colours, the sound of dhak drums, the crowds. But she had never been inside. "Is it okay for me to come?" she asked Priya. "Will your family mind?"

Priya laughed. "My dadi says the more people who celebrate, the more joy there is. Please come."

So Mitu went. She sat quietly and watched. She did not understand every part of the ritual, but she noticed the care in people's faces — the same devotion she felt during prayer, just expressed differently. She watched Priya's grandmother light incense with trembling, reverent hands. She tasted the prasad Priya offered her. She felt, very clearly, that she was in a sacred place, and she behaved accordingly.

On the way home, she thought: *Bangladesh is made of all of this — Eid, Puja, Christmas, Buddha Purnima. Each festival belongs to someone's family, someone's history, someone's heart. Treating any of them as lesser is not just rude. It is wrong.*

Bangladesh is one of the world's most religiously and culturally diverse nations. Muslims, Hindus, Christians, Buddhists, and indigenous communities — the Chakma, Marma, Santal, and others — have lived side by side in this land for centuries. That history is not always without difficulty. But it is also a history of shared harvests, shared rivers, shared grief in times of disaster, and shared joy at festival time. A Bangladesh that honours its diversity is stronger, more creative, and more resilient than one that does not.

Respect does not require agreement. It does not require that you adopt another person's beliefs. It only requires that you treat their faith, their culture, and their identity as worthy of dignity — because they are.

What Tolerance Looks Like at School

Tolerance is not passive. It is not simply putting up with someone who is different. Real tolerance is **active respect** — choosing, every day, to treat others' identities as worth protecting.

Here is what that looks like in a school community:

- **Use the right greeting for each person's context.** "Assalamu Alaikum" is appropriate among Muslim classmates; learn the appropriate greeting in other contexts too. When in doubt, a warm "hello" or "good morning" is always respectful.
- **Do not mock different foods, clothing, or traditions.** If a classmate brings food you do not recognise, ask about it with curiosity — not scorn. "What is that? It smells amazing" is respectful. "Ew, what's that?" is not.
- **Defend a classmate who is being mocked for their religion or culture.** This is harder than staying silent. It is also more important. You do not need to make a big speech — a simple "That's not funny, stop it" is enough.
- **Be curious, not dismissive.** If you do not understand a custom or practice, ask respectfully. "Can you tell me about Holi? I've seen the pictures but I don't understand what it means" is a question that honours both the tradition and the person.
- **Never use someone's religion, ethnicity, or community as an insult.** This includes indirect insults — jokes that "aren't meant seriously." If it could hurt, it does hurt.

Community Challenge — Week 2

"One Tradition, Many Meanings"

This week, research one tradition from a community or culture different from your own.

Options (choose one, or propose another with your teacher's approval):

- A Hindu festival (e.g., Saraswati Puja, Diwali, Holi)
- A Christian tradition (e.g., Christmas, Easter)
- A Buddhist observance (e.g., Buddha Purnima)
- A tradition of an indigenous community of Bangladesh (e.g., Chakma, Marma, Garo)

Your research should answer:

1. What is the tradition called, and which community celebrates it?
2. What does it mean? What is its history or religious significance?
3. What do people do during this tradition?
4. What does it teach us about what that community values?

Your presentation to the class should be positive and respectful — you are not comparing this tradition to your own, or ranking traditions. You are simply introducing something meaningful that belongs to your neighbours.

Note for students: If you are unsure how to find information, your teacher, the school library, or a trusted family member from that community are excellent starting points. Asking directly — politely — is often the best research of all.

Leadership Reflection

Write your answer in your notebook, or discuss with a partner.

"What can I do if I see a classmate being excluded or mocked because of their religion, culture, or background? What are the exact words I could say? Practice saying them out loud."

Teacher Notes

This is one of the most sensitive chapters in the curriculum. Handle it with care and with confidence — both matter.

Use local, positive examples. If your school community includes students from different religious or ethnic backgrounds, this chapter is an opportunity to celebrate that. If it is more homogeneous, focus on Bangladesh's national diversity — students do not need to know someone personally to extend respect.

Be attentive to any existing tensions in your school community before teaching this chapter. If there are recent incidents of religious or ethnic tension in the local area, consult your headteacher about how to approach the material responsibly.

The Mitu/Priya narrative is designed to model respectful curiosity across religious lines. Reinforce the key message: Mitu does not convert, does not compromise her own beliefs, and does not participate in ritual that is not hers — she simply attends with respect and openness. This is the appropriate model.

Do not allow the class discussion to become comparative ("which religion is better"). If this arises, redirect firmly: "We are not comparing — we are learning. Every tradition in this room deserves equal respect."

Parent Corner

[NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

(English source text for translation:)

This week, talk with your child about a tradition from another culture that you respect or admire. It might be a festival you have seen celebrated by neighbours, a custom you encountered growing up, or something you have simply

heard about and found beautiful. Share why it impresses you. Ask your child what they are learning about diversity this week at school. Your openness to other cultures teaches your child, in the most direct way possible, that all people deserve respect.

Chapter 3: Our Environment, Our Responsibility

Virtue: Responsibility | দায়িত্ব [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

Learning Objective: Students will design and execute one environment-improvement action in their community, and connect environmental etiquette to environmental survival.

Project Introduction

Here is a fact that might surprise you: Bangladesh is one of the most climate-vulnerable countries in the world.

That means that the floods, cyclones, and rising rivers that affect millions of Bangladeshi families every year are made worse by environmental damage — both globally and locally. We cannot control what the rest of the world does. But we can control what we do.

And what we do matters more than you might think.

When Rafi dropped a packet of chips on the street last year, he thought: it's just one wrapper. What difference does it make? He knows the answer now. One wrapper, multiplied by every person on that street, multiplied by every day of the year, fills the drains. Filled drains cannot carry rainwater. Rainwater that has nowhere to go floods the street — and then the ground floors of buildings — and then basements and lower rooms where families store food, sleep, and keep their lives. "Littering is not just rude," his environmental studies teacher told the class. "In Bangladesh, it blocks drains that flood your home during monsoon."

Rafi has not dropped a wrapper since.

But this chapter is not just about what not to do. It is about what to do. Bangladesh's rivers, forests, wetlands, and coastlines are among the most beautiful and ecologically rich environments on earth. The Sundarbans — the world's largest mangrove forest — is home to Royal Bengal Tigers and is a shield that protects coastal communities from storm surges. The Haor wetlands of the northeast are breeding grounds for hundreds of bird species. These places belong to all of us. And all of us are responsible for them.

Environmental responsibility starts small. It starts with a wrapper in a bin. It ends — if enough of us commit to it — with a country that can breathe, a country whose rivers run clean, a country that can withstand whatever the climate brings.

That country starts with you.

Environmental Etiquette — The Rules

These are not suggestions. They are commitments.

- **Never litter.** If there is no bin nearby, put your wrapper in your bag or pocket and find one later. The street is not a bin. The river is not a bin. The school courtyard is not a bin.
- **Conserve water.** Turn off taps fully after use. Do not leave water running while you soap your hands. Do not use more water than you need when washing dishes, clothes, or your face. Bangladesh's groundwater is precious.
- **Protect trees and plants.** Do not break branches, strip bark, carve into trunks, or uproot plants for no reason. Trees provide shade, clean air, and stability to soil. They take years to grow and seconds to destroy.
- **Report damage to public spaces.** If you see a broken bin, a blocked drain, dumped rubbish, or a damaged public space — tell an adult, a teacher, or a local authority. You are not responsible for fixing it yourself. But you are responsible for not ignoring it.
- **Use less plastic.** Carry a reusable water bottle. Say no to plastic bags when you can. Every piece of plastic that does not exist is a piece that cannot end up in a drain, a river, or a turtle's stomach.

Community Challenge — Week-Long Project

"The Neighbourhood Clean-Up"

This week, you will organise and carry out a 30-minute neighbourhood clean-up with 3–5 classmates.

Step 1: Plan (Day 1–2)

- Choose a safe, manageable location near your school or home (your teacher will help identify suitable sites).
- Get permission from your teacher and parents.
- Collect what you need: gloves (if available), bags for rubbish, a camera or phone for photos.
- Assign roles: Team Leader, Photographer, Reporter.

Step 2: Act (Day 3–4)

- Arrive at your chosen site together.
- Take a BEFORE photograph.
- Clean for 30 minutes. Work carefully and safely — do not touch anything dangerous (broken glass, syringes, chemicals). Alert an adult if you find anything hazardous.
- Take an AFTER photograph.

Step 3: Report (Day 5)

- Present your before-and-after photos to the class.
- Tell the class: How much did you collect? What did you find? How did you feel before, during, and after? Did anyone in the community react to what you were doing? What did they say?
- End with one recommendation: What could the community do to prevent this site from getting dirty again?

Safety note: Your teacher and parents must approve your clean-up location. Never clean up in a location that feels unsafe. Never touch materials that could be hazardous. Wash hands thoroughly after the activity.

Leadership Reflection

Write your answer in your notebook, or discuss with a partner.

"What one environmental habit can I commit to for the rest of the school year? Be specific: not 'I will be better about litter' but 'I will carry my wrappers home if there is no bin nearby.' Write your commitment and sign your name."

Teacher Notes

Identifying a clean-up site: Choose a site that is genuinely safe, physically manageable in 30 minutes, and has visible impact. The school grounds, a nearby lane, or a community pathway are good options. Avoid roadside sites with heavy traffic, riverbanks without safe access, or sites with potential hazardous waste.

Before the challenge: Brief parents in advance — students may need permission to be off school grounds, and parental participation in the clean-up is strongly encouraged. A parent who joins their child's clean-up is making a statement about environmental responsibility that will last years.

The "Reporter" role is important: the student who reports to the class should connect the visible results (amount of rubbish collected) to the wider argument of the chapter (environmental etiquette as environmental survival). Help them make that connection explicit.

Connect to NGO effectiveness: Research confirms that community-level environmental actions led by young people have measurable impact on community norms [SOURCE_BD_24]. This is not a token activity — it is real civic work.

Parent Corner

[NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

(English source text for translation:)

Your child's class is organising a neighbourhood clean-up this week. If at all possible, join them. Even 15 minutes of participation sends your child a message more powerful than any lecture: *environmental responsibility is for everyone, not just children*. Ask them what they found, how they felt, and what they think should happen next. If joining is not possible, ask about the experience when they return. Celebrate what they did — it was real community work.

Chapter 4: Professional Etiquette Preview — Ready for the World

Virtue: Discipline + Respect | শৃঙ্খলা + সম্মান [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

Learning Objective: Students will demonstrate 4 professional etiquette behaviours in a mock formal setting, and articulate why professional habits built now will serve them throughout their lives.

Project Introduction

Rafi is ten years old. He is not applying for a job. He has not been to university. He has not had a formal meeting or given a presentation to a board of directors.

But he will. And the habits he builds right now — in Class 5, at this school, in this community — will follow him when he does.

Here is something Rafi has noticed: the adults he admires most are not just knowledgeable. They are reliable. They show up on time. They speak clearly and confidently. They dress in a way that shows they take the occasion seriously. They listen without interrupting. They put their phone away when speaking to someone. These things, Rafi is beginning to understand, are not small things. They are the foundation of trust.

Rafi imagines his future. Maybe he will be a doctor — he has always wanted to help sick people get better. Maybe an engineer, building bridges that hold. Maybe a teacher, like the teachers who changed his life. Whatever he becomes, he knows that the skills required to do that work well are not just technical. They are human: the ability to show up, to communicate with respect, to present yourself as someone who can be relied upon.

"Secondary school will be different," his teacher told the class. "The expectations will be more formal. The consequences of being unprepared will be more serious. Class 5 is your runway — use it."

Professional etiquette is not about being stiff or artificial. It is about showing people, through your behaviour, that you value their time and take the interaction seriously. It is the outward expression of an inner attitude: *I am here. I am ready. I respect you.*

Class 5 is not too early to begin. In fact, it is exactly the right time.

Professional Etiquette Skills

Punctuality Being on time is not just practical — it is a message. When you arrive late, the message (even if unintended) is: *my time is more important than yours*. When you arrive on time, or early, the message is: *I take this seriously and I respect you*. Practise being the first one seated, the one whose materials are already out, the one who is ready when the lesson begins.

Formal speech Different situations require different language. With friends at break time, casual speech is natural and appropriate. In a formal setting — presenting to the class, speaking to a headteacher, attending a formal event — full sentences, clear pronunciation, and respectful vocabulary are required. This does not mean being unnatural. It means being adaptable. Practise: instead of "yeah, I dunno," say "I am not sure, sir, but I will find out."

Appropriate dress Clean clothes, worn neatly, appropriate to the occasion. This does not require expensive clothing. It requires care: a clean uniform, shoes that are not muddy, hair that is tidy. Dress tells people how you regard an occasion. Dress for formal events as though they matter — because they do.

Greetings in formal settings In Bangladesh, appropriate greetings vary by context, age, and relationship. With adults in formal settings: a respectful greeting (Assalamu Alaikum / Namaskar as appropriate), a slight bow of acknowledgement, or — where culturally appropriate and expected — a firm handshake (men). Eye contact communicates confidence and honesty. Avoiding eye contact can be misread as disrespect or dishonesty in formal contexts.

Phone etiquette in formal settings In a meeting, a formal presentation, a classroom lesson, or a conversation with an adult: phone off or on silent, in your bag or pocket. No checking messages. No texting. No scrolling. The person in front of you deserves your full attention. This single habit will mark you out, in every formal context you encounter, as someone serious.

Community Challenge — "Professional Me"

This week, each student will design their **Professional Me Profile**.

Part 1: My Future Write or draw your future career. It does not need to be certain — you can have two or three possibilities. Answer:

- What do I want to do?
- Why does this work matter to the community?
- What kind of professional will I be?

Part 2: My Professional Habits Choose 3 professional habits from this chapter (or add your own) that you commit to bringing to your future career. For each habit, write:

- The habit
- Why it matters in your chosen career
- One thing you can practise this week to build it

Part 3: Present it Share your Professional Me profile with the class. Stand up. Speak clearly. Begin with: "My name is [name]. My future career is [career]. The professional habits I am building are..."

The Mock Formal Interview

At the end of this chapter, your class will hold a **Mock Formal Interview**.

Your teacher will be the interviewer. You will be the candidate.

The interview will go like this:

1. You knock on the classroom door and enter when invited.
2. You greet your teacher formally.
3. You sit when invited — back straight, hands visible, feet on the floor.
4. Your teacher asks you: *"Tell me about your future goals and the professional habits you are working to build."*
5. You answer in full sentences, clearly and confidently, for approximately 1 minute.
6. You thank your teacher and exit.

You will be assessed on:

- Your greeting
- Your posture and bearing

- The clarity of your speech
- The quality of your answer
- Your exit (gracious, not rushed)

This is not a test of what you know. It is a test of how you show up.

Leadership Reflection

Write your answer in your notebook, or discuss with a partner.

"If I could give one piece of advice to a Class 1 student about how to behave well — one thing I wish I had known when I was six years old — what would I say? Write it as if you are writing them a letter."

Teacher Notes

The Mock Formal Interview is the centrepiece of this chapter. Run it as formally as circumstances allow — rearrange the classroom if possible, have the student actually knock on the door, maintain the formal register throughout. Students often find this awkward and funny at first; that awkwardness is part of the learning. Debriefing afterward (what felt strange? what felt right? what would you do differently?) is as important as the interview itself.

Be attentive to anxiety. For some students, formal performance is genuinely frightening. Normalise this: "Professionals feel nervous in formal settings too. The skill is performing well anyway." Rehearsal and repeated exposure reduce anxiety over time.

Connect to Class 5's transition to secondary school. Many students will soon sit admission interviews, formal assessments, or attend schools with stricter behavioural codes. This chapter is direct preparation for that transition.

Note on phone etiquette: Many students in Class 5 now have their own phones. This is not the moment to debate whether that is appropriate — it is the moment to address, practically, how phones should be managed in formal contexts.

Parent Corner

[NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

(English source text for translation:)

This week, talk with your child about what "professional" means in your family's context. What do the adults they admire most — relatives, neighbours, community leaders — do that makes them impressive? What habits do you hope your child will carry into adult life? Share a memory from your own life of a moment when you had to be professional — perhaps a job interview, a formal meeting, a difficult conversation. Tell them what you did, and what you wish you had done. These conversations connect school learning to the real world in ways that textbooks alone cannot.

Chapter 5: Building My Community — Etiquette Ambassador

Virtue: Community | সম্প্রদায় [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

Learning Objective: Students will design and deliver one community etiquette action, and reflect on their role as a model for others.

Project Introduction

Mitu stood at the front of the Class 1 classroom and felt something she had not expected: nervous.

She had prepared carefully. She knew exactly what she wanted to say. She had practised at home, in front of the mirror, twice. She had made five stickers — yellow stars with "Polite Star!" written on them in her neatest handwriting. But now, looking at the twenty-six tiny faces staring back at her with complete, trusting attention, she felt the weight of it.

They are watching me, she thought. *What I do right now is going to stay with them.*

She took a breath. She smiled. And she began.

"Good morning, everyone. My name is Mitu, and I am in Class 5. Today I am going to teach you three magic words. Does anyone know what the magic words are?"

Twenty-six hands shot up. Mitu felt something lift in her chest.

It had been her teacher's idea — the "Good Manners Morning." Class 5 students would each visit a younger class and teach one etiquette lesson. Mitu had chosen the magic words (please, thank you, sorry), a proper greeting, and — her favourite — the art of listening without interrupting. For the listening lesson, she had played a game: one child speaks, and everyone else counts to five in their head before responding. "That pause," she told them, "is respect."

When she gave out the stickers, two children hugged her.

On the other side of the school, Rafi was finishing his "Respect Week" presentation to his own class. He had organised it himself: each day of the week, the class would focus on one respect habit — greetings on Monday, listening on Tuesday, phone-free lunch on Wednesday, community clean-up on Thursday, and a Respect Pledge on Friday. He had made a poster. He had led discussions. He had, on Thursday, organised a 20-minute clean-up of the school garden.

"I thought I was teaching my class," Rafi told his teacher afterward. "But I learned more than anyone."

This is the secret of the Etiquette Ambassador.

Research confirms what Mitu and Rafi discovered firsthand: when young people become role models — when they move from receiving knowledge to sharing it — their own understanding deepens, their confidence grows, and their community benefits [SOURCE_BD_25]. Teaching is not the final stage of learning. It is where learning becomes real.

You have spent this year growing. Now you will lead.

Bangladesh needs citizens who do not just know the right thing — but who do it, and who inspire others to do it too. That is what an Etiquette Ambassador is. That is what you are becoming.

What an Etiquette Ambassador Does

An Etiquette Ambassador is not a prefect who punishes. An Etiquette Ambassador is a model who inspires.

Here is what that looks like in practice:

- **Models excellent manners in all spaces, every day.** Not just when a teacher is watching. Not just on formal occasions. Every day, in every space — classroom, corridor, canteen, community — you behave as someone worth watching.
- **Gently corrects others — with kindness, not condescension.** If a classmate drops litter or speaks rudely, you can say something. But how you say it matters as much as what you say. "Hey, there's a bin over there" is kinder and more effective than "You're so rude." The goal is to help, not to shame.
- **Teaches younger students one etiquette lesson.** This is the formal Ambassador act — visiting a younger class, running a morning session, creating a resource. You will plan and deliver this as part of your Ambassador project.
- **Organises one class or community etiquette action.** A Respect Week. A Litter Pick. A Good Manners Poster for the school. A Polite Home Week with your family. Something that goes beyond yourself.
- **Reports on their impact to the class.** At the end of the term, you will present: What did you do? Who did it reach? What changed? What did you learn?

The Grand Community Challenge — Your Etiquette Ambassador Project

This is the most important project of the year. You will design and deliver your own Etiquette Ambassador project over this term.

You must:

1. **Identify your project.** Choose from the options below, or design your own with your teacher's approval.
2. **Plan it.** Use the My Community Pledge and Action Plan (at the end of this book) to structure your project.
3. **Do it.** Execute your plan, with your teacher's and parents' support.
4. **Document it.** Keep a project log — notes, photos, drawings, quotes from people you reached.
5. **Present it.** At the Class 5 Ambassador Showcase, present your project to classmates (and parents, if invited).

Project options:

Project	What it involves
Teach a younger class	Prepare and deliver a 20–30 minute etiquette lesson to Class 1, 2, or 3
Good Manners Poster	Design and display a poster for the school on one etiquette theme
Litter Pick + Report	Organise a community clean-up and present findings to the class
Polite Home Week	Run a week-long family challenge: one etiquette focus per day. Report to class.
Respect Assembly	Organise a 15-minute class assembly on one of the year's virtues

Design your own	Propose your own project in writing to your teacher for approval
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Your project will be assessed on:

- Planning: Did you have a clear plan? Did you follow it?
- Impact: Did your project reach other people? How many? What changed?
- Reflection: What did you learn? What would you do differently?
- Presentation: Did you communicate your project clearly and confidently?

Leadership Reflection

This is the final reflection of Class 5. Take your time with it.

"What kind of Bangladesh do I want to grow up in? What does it look, feel, and sound like? And — specifically, practically — what am I doing right now to help build it?"

Write at least one full paragraph. This reflection will be shared at the Ambassador Showcase.

Teacher Notes

The Ambassador Showcase is the culmination of the year's work. Treat it as a significant event — rearrange the room, invite parents where possible, give students time to prepare their presentations properly. Students who have genuinely invested in their projects deserve a proper audience.

Do not allow projects to become tokenistic. A student who prints a poster but does not display it, or who plans a lesson but does not deliver it, has not completed the challenge. The standard is real-world action and real-world impact, however modest.

Differentiate by capacity, not ambition. Some students will organise ambitious projects; others will manage something smaller. Both are valid. A student who genuinely runs a Polite Home Week with their family and can articulate what changed has achieved something real, even if it is less visible than a school assembly.

Celebrate the Ambassador identity. Consider creating a simple certificate, badge, or public recognition for students who complete their projects. The "Etiquette Ambassador" title should feel earned.

Relevant background: NGO pilot programme research confirms measurable community impact from youth-led etiquette and civic responsibility programmes [SOURCE_BD_25]. The responsible decision-making and civic participation outcomes align with SEL frameworks [SOURCE_GL_01][SOURCE_GL_03].

Parent Corner

[NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

(English source text for translation:)

Your child is now an Etiquette Ambassador. This is not a metaphor — they have a real project to design and deliver this term, something that will reach other people in your school or community and make things a little better. Ask them what their project is. Ask how you can help. Offer to join them if you can. Celebrate their initiative — not just when it succeeds, but while they are working on it, because effort and commitment deserve recognition too. At the end of term, their class will hold an Ambassador Showcase. We hope you can attend.

End of Book: My Community Pledge and Action Plan

Fill in this page carefully. This is your commitment. Sign it.

My Etiquette Ambassador Project Plan

My name: _____

My class: _____

My school: _____

Date: _____

My Pledge

Complete this sentence:

"I will be an Etiquette Ambassador by...

...and I will do this because I believe that Bangladesh is better when every person in it is treated with dignity and respect."

Signed: _____ Date: _____

My Project: What I Will Do

My project title: _____

What I will do: (Describe your project in 3–5 sentences)

My Action Plan

What I will do	When	Who will help me	How I will measure success

My Goal

By the end of this term, I want to say:

My Reflection (to be completed at the end of the project)

What I did:

Who it reached:

What changed because of my project:

What I learned about myself:

What I would do differently next time:

"The greatest way to live with honour in this world is to be what we pretend to be." — Socrates

"A person who feels appreciated will always do more than what is expected." — Anonymous

"The youth is the hope of our future." — Attributed to José Rizal

Glossary

English Term	Bengali	Definition
Citizen	নাগরিক [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	A person who legally belongs to a country and has rights and responsibilities under its laws
Civic pride	নাগরিক গর্ব [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	A feeling of satisfaction and responsibility about the community you belong to, leading you to care for it and contribute to it
Constitution	সংবিধান [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	The highest law of a country, which defines the rights of citizens and the structure of government
Community	সম্প্রদায় [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	A group of people who live in the same area or share common values, interests, or identity
Diversity	বৈচিত্র্য [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	The presence of many different types of people, cultures, religions, or ideas in one place
Tolerance	সহিষ্ণুতা [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	The ability to accept and respect people whose beliefs, behaviour, or customs are different from your own
Responsibility	দায়িত্ব [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	A duty or obligation to behave in a certain way, or to take care of something or someone
Environment	পরিবেশ [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	The natural world — air, water, land, plants, and animals — that surrounds us and supports life
Etiquette	শিষ্টাচার [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	The rules of polite, respectful behaviour in social situations
Ambassador	রাষ্ট্রদূত / প্রতিনিধি [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	A person who represents a group, country, or set of values — in this context, a student who models and teaches good behaviour
Punctuality	সময়ানুবর্তিতা [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	The habit of arriving or completing things at the agreed time; being reliably on time
Discipline	শৃঙ্খলা [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	The practice of training oneself to behave in a controlled, regular, and focused way
Respect	সম্মান [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	Treating people, places, and ideas as having value and worth
Rights	অধিকার [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	The things every person is entitled to — such as education, safety, and freedom — protected by law
Liberation War	মুক্তিযুদ্ধ [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	Bangladesh's 1971 war of independence from Pakistan, through which the nation won its freedom and established its democratic values
Climate vulnerability	জলবায়ু দুর্বলতা [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	The degree to which a country or region is at risk from the effects of climate change, such as floods, cyclones, and rising sea levels
Monsoon	বর্ষা [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	The seasonal heavy rainfall that occurs in Bangladesh and other South Asian countries, typically from June to September
Indigenous	আদিবাসী [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	Originating naturally in a particular place; used to describe communities whose ancestors have lived in a region for thousands of years

Interfaith	আন্তঃধর্মীয় [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	Between or involving people of different religious faiths
Pledge	অঙ্গীকার / প্রতিশ্রুতি [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]	A sincere and formal promise to do or not do something

Source Notes — Curriculum Team Reference

The following source placeholders require verification, formatting, and citation before final publication. All sources should be reviewed for accuracy, recency, and appropriateness for a Class 5 Bangladesh context. Do not print this section in student-facing copies.

Bangladesh-Specific Sources

- **[SOURCE_BD_12]** — Research on juvenile delinquency, moral degradation, and youth behaviour in the Bangladeshi context. Referenced in Chapter 1 Teacher Notes. *[Curriculum team: verify source, author, publisher, date. Confirm relevance to civic responsibility framing.]*
- **[SOURCE_BD_21]** — Research on eve-teasing and community responsibility in Bangladesh. Referenced in front matter sourcing for chapters on community safety and gender respect. *[Curriculum team: verify. Note: this topic may require a dedicated future chapter or supplementary material for Class 5–6 level.]*
- **[SOURCE_BD_22]** — Additional source on eve-teasing and social responsibility. *[Curriculum team: verify and confirm whether distinct from SOURCE_BD_21.]*
- **[SOURCE_BD_23]** — Additional source on community responsibility dimensions of eve-teasing and public behaviour. *[Curriculum team: verify.]*
- **[SOURCE_BD_24]** — Research on NGO effectiveness in community development. Referenced in Chapter 3 Teacher Notes (environmental etiquette and community norms). *[Curriculum team: confirm source — likely a Bangladesh NGO sector evaluation or academic paper. Provide full citation.]*
- **[SOURCE_BD_25]** — Research on NGO pilot programme impact, specifically youth-led community behaviour change. Referenced in Chapter 5 Project Introduction and Teacher Notes. *[Curriculum team: confirm this is Blu Foundation's own pilot data or an external source. If internal, confirm it can be cited publicly.]*

Global / Academic Sources

- **[SOURCE_GL_01]** — Social-Emotional Learning (SEL): responsible decision-making and civic participation framework. Referenced in Chapter 5 Teacher Notes. *[Curriculum team: likely CASEL framework or equivalent — confirm exact source and edition.]*
- **[SOURCE_GL_03]** — Additional SEL source: civic participation outcomes. Referenced in Chapter 5 Teacher Notes. *[Curriculum team: verify. Confirm whether SOURCE_GL_02 is intentionally omitted from this document or exists in another module.]*

- **[SOURCE_UK_04]** — Research on project-based learning for older primary students. Referenced in A Note to Teachers. *[Curriculum team: likely a UK Department for Education or EEF (Education Endowment Foundation) publication. Verify exact source, confirm applicability to Bangladesh classroom context, and note in teacher guidance if there are adaptation considerations.]*

End of source notes.

End of BLU_D09 — Class 5 Textbook: "My Community, My Responsibility"

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